

Study Questions: Action

1. How does Active Inference dissolve the traditional separation between perception and action?
2. Explain the concept of action as "self-fulfilling prophecy." How does proprioceptive prediction drive movement?
3. Compare the classical computational model of motor control (goal → plan → command) with the Active Inference model (prediction → error → movement).
4. What are affordances (Gibson), and how does Active Inference formalize them?
5. Explain the Expected Free Energy (EFE) decomposition into pragmatic value (risk) and epistemic value (ambiguity). Give a concrete example.
6. How does the concept of epistemic action (exploring to reduce uncertainty) relate to scientific inquiry?
7. Evaluate the claim: "Curiosity is the drive to minimize expected ambiguity." Is this reductive, or does it capture something genuine?
8. How does Active Inference relate to Frankfurt's hierarchical account of free will?
9. Is the Active Inference account of action compatibilist, libertarian, or hard determinist? Defend your classification.
10. How does Dreyfus's phenomenology of skill (from "novice" to "expert") map onto the Active Inference framework?
11. What does Friston mean by "I don't move my arm because I want to; I move my arm because I predict I will"?
12. How does pragmatist philosophy (Dewey's organism-environment transaction) relate to action as inference?
13. If all action is prediction error minimization, how do we distinguish between intentional and reflexive action?
14. What role does the C vector (prior preferences) play in action selection? How does this relate to the concept of motivation?
15. How does Active Inference explain the phenomenon of "motor imagery" — imagining an action without performing it?
16. Compare Active Inference's account of exploration (epistemic action) with Berlyne's concept of "epistemic curiosity."

17. Can an agent perform an action it did not predict? What would this imply for the framework?
18. How does the concept of "active inference" relate to the philosophical concept of *praxis* (Aristotle)?
19. If action is inference, does a sleeping person who tosses and turns act? Where is the line?
20. Construct a philosophical argument: Does Active Inference's account of action leave room for moral responsibility, or does it undermine it?